

Breathing life into films

We converse with D-Box Technologies to gain a deeper understanding of their motion-induced cinema seats which they have brought over to India now

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d What does D-Box offer and how does the motion feedback technology work?

Vanessa: We offer a motion immersive experience in cinemas (movie theatres) that is based on the sound of the title with our motion-induced seats. We have a special motion coding team that works on coding based on sound. What they see as well, but primarily what you hear. They're artists, and they code within what they feel will add to the movie experience. The code is inducted into the title and sent to exhibitors all around the world, PVR India is now one of them. We have a total of 11 screens between Delhi and Mumbai as of now.

d Is your technology completely unique or does it build on tech that is already existing?

Vanessa: We add code to the DCP (Digital Cinema Package) or the code can also be pushed to the auditoriums over the internet. It is basically technology added to what exists already. However, our seats are unique and have been built through years of research and development. Each D-Box seat is connected to a set of actuators (motors that control vibration, pitch, roll and heave of a seat) which are then connected to a motion-controlling device.

d What sets you apart from your competition, for example, 4DX?

Vanessa: Our experience possesses three main benefits that differentiate us in the

market. Firstly, comfort. We're a motion immersive experience but comfort is non-negotiable for us, and the consumer. Secondly, ultra-synchronisation. The motion is well-synchronised with every title we take on. Lastly, the individual experience. A viewer can set our seats to output the intensity of motion that they are comfortable with, using the controller we have incorporated in each seat. Every person in the audience can customise the motion intensity as per their individualistic preferences. We also continually ensure that our technology gets more efficient and durable over time.

d What was the reception like in the other countries, where you have been present for a while now? Have you had any trial runs in India, if yes, what was the reception like here?

Vanessa: The experience is present in 42 countries now, which amounts to 720 screens across the world. It would be a lie for me to say that the reception in every country is the same. In fact, every country is different. That's essentially the challenge. You want to ensure that you adapt to the particular market well. India may be different and we will adapt as needed.

In Germany, we have a 100 D-Box screens. Germans are very specific about their technology and they've gone on the wagon with D-Box and it's been an amazing experience. The occupancy rates are extremely good.

We haven't really done any trials runs on Indian audience yet, except for the

PVR executives and now, of course, the media. PVR, over their years of experience in the country, believe that Indian audiences are receptive to these kind of premium experiences and will pay extra to enjoy the uniqueness of it. For us, diversifying content is a great way for us to show that our technology can work with various types of content all over the world. India, Bollywood specifically, is a great example of that.

d How do you tackle slower-paced films that don't necessarily have the 'boom' and 'thud' present in fast-paced action movies? How do you adapt your technology to those?

Vanessa: When we say we do 70 different Hollywood titles in a year, not all 70 titles have the pace of say, 'The Fast and The Furious'. Many of them, such as horror, suspense, drama and more, have much slower paces. In such titles, it's not necessarily about the amount of motion you induct, but about the texture, the subtle vibrations and other such nuances. Of course, there are no external effects such as wind and water, but we think that while that has its place and audience, we have an audience as well. We make sure, that when we go on board with a title, our experts take a close look at it and code very specifically, in a way that matches the pace, the urgency or the mood. We add value for the movie-goer. At D-Box, we can have the intensity if called for, or we can be very subtle and surprise you with the soft, but still jolting motion. 